the age of eighteen, to join the British military mission under Major Hart, as a Lieutenant of infantry with the forces of H. R. H. Prince Abbas Mirza. Charles does not appear in the British Army List, but his letters, notes, and sketches indicate education and training in military tactics. During his brief career as a soldier he distinguished himself by winning the Persian order of the Rising Sun and Lion, second class, for gallantry in action, and comported himself in such fashion as to win the approbation and confidence not only of his military colleagues, but also of those highly placed in the Persian government.

As a result of connections thus established, in 1829, when Persian finances became so muddled that most of the British military mission had to be released, Charles found himself set up as a merchant, financed by his father, and working through Sadik Bey, and the firm of Hanson, of London and Constantinople. Brilliant and bold in his conceptions, he was successful beyond expectations at the outset, and was probably the first Englishman to ship goods from the mother country through the Black Sea directly to Trebizond in Turkey, thence by relatively easy caravan stages to the markets of Persia, instead of the previous prohibitively expensive route via the port of Bushire in the Persian Gulf. He traveled back and forth between Persia and England constantly during the years 1830–1836, executing private and public commissions, and on at least one occasion, acted as King's Messenger for the British Foreign Office. His restless imagination running riot at the enormous possibilities opened up before him, he kept pyramiding venture on venture until finally, in 1836, the bubble burst. Thereafter, a combination of circumstances such as ill-health, "trouble in the Balkans," inability to satisfy the clamorings of creditors, and perhaps, interest in newer and greener pastures served to prevent his return to Persia. He died at Aix-la-Chapelle during the winter of 1854–1855.

In the meantime, his younger brother Edward, whom he had brought out with him in 1830 and associated in the business, was left in Persia, practically a hostage in the hands of Charles's Persian creditors, who thus vainly hoped to compel the older brother's return. At first Edward's position was extremely precarious, for apart from the risk to his person he led a hand-to-mouth existence which was in sharp contrast to his previous estate as "a prosperous and thriving merchant." But his singularly winning disposition (his widow could still say, twenty-five years after his death, that "he was the most all-loved person" she had ever known) enabled him to retain former friends and make new ones among both Europeans and natives, even those who had suffered from the unhappy outcome of Charles's speculations. Prince Bahman Mirza secured his appointment as civil governor of two small villages, an appointment which, because the villages were in the neighborhood of a community of Nestorian

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